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Sèrie 2 - A

	Qualificació	Etiqueta de qualificació
Comprensió escrita		
Redacció		
Comprensió oral		

Etiqueta identificadora de l'alumne/a

Ubicació del tribunal .....

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ARE LOVE-LOCKS ON BRIDGES ROMANTIC OR A MENACE?

Beautiful bridges in Paris are being ruined by an epidemic of **padlocks**. But is the growing trend for love-locks a thoughtless act of vandalism, or just a harmless expression of love?

It seemed romantic when Carolyn Barnabo and Clive Roberts attached a padlock to the Pont des Arts and symbolically threw the key into the Seine. Five years later they are married and their love is still strong, but Carolyn's fondness for love-**locks** certainly isn't. "It's just out of control and I feel so bad that we contributed to it," says Carolyn. "This beautiful bridge is ruined." There were just a few love-locks on the bridge when she attached hers and posted photos on her blog. Now there are thousands on bridges all over Paris.

The locks first started appearing on bridges in Paris around 2006, shortly after young couples in Italy had begun attaching padlocks to the Ponte Milvio over Rome's river Tiber, mimicking the protagonists of a popular Italian novel. In 2007 the **mayor** of Rome introduced fines for anyone leaving a padlock on this bridge. "After Rome started forbidding the locks, couples from all over Europe came to Paris," Lorna Taylor explains. She and friend Lisa Anselmo started the No Love-Locks campaign in January 2014. "The delicate Pont des Arts, which has become a freakish mass of indistinguishable metal pieces, is now in mortal danger," Lisa Anselmo adds. They say the City of Love has now become the City of Locks, and they have counted at least eight bridges over the Seine and three over the Canal Saint Martin where padlocks have spread "like fungus." Anselmo thinks that this trend "**defaces** and damages historic structures, and it is already imposing itself on other cities around Europe, where some of the bridges involved are hundreds of years old."

The padlock supposedly symbolises a **bond** between two people in love—but local authorities are now removing some padlocks from time to time. It was only after a wall on the Pont des Arts collapsed under the weight of the locks that the Paris authorities got serious about putting an end to the practice. "Some of the **railings** have 500 kilograms of locks by the time they are removed. The one that collapsed weighed 700 kilograms. They're a costly problem for the city and also a safety one," Lorna Taylor says. Now, city officials in Paris are experimenting with panels of thick glass to protect the bridges from the damage caused by padlocks.

Described as an "epidemic" by the No Love-Locks campaign, padlocks are spreading around the world, and they are no longer restricted to bridges. Love-locks have appeared on the top of the Eiffel Tower and others can be found on fences in London. And they are not restricted to tourist destinations either—four have already appeared on St Botolph's Bridge in Boston, Lincolnshire, which only opened in February 2014. Many businesses have benefitted from this **trend**: some offer engraved padlocks in heart shapes and even one website suggests locations to attach them in Amsterdam, Chicago, Prague, Rome or Sydney. Lisa Anselmo says: "If a city wants to designate a space uniquely for love-locks, and restrict the practice on non-designated areas, that's not a bad idea. The question is how to find a way for love-locks and **heritage** to co-exist."

Despite attaching her own love lock in Paris five years ago, Carolyn now regrets that she contributed to this horrendous sight. "I would hate to see any beautiful bridges in England get like that. It was a nice idea, but I hope it dies out soon."

Text adapted from *BBC News* (May 5, 2014)

padlock, lock: cadenat / candado
mayor: alcalde
defaces (to deface): desfigurar
bond: lligam / vínculo
railing: barana / barandilla
trend: tendència, moda / tendencia, moda
heritage: patrimoni històric / patrimonio histórico

Part 1: Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer according to the text. Only ONE answer is correct.

[4 points: 0.5 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.16 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

	Espai per al corrector/a		
	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1. Carolyn Barnabo and Clive Roberts left a lock on a bridge in Paris ☐ because it was a romantic thing to do. ☐ to contribute to the Parisian tradition. ☐ because they were fond of locks. ☐ in order to write an entry in a blog.	☐	☐	☐
2. Which of the sentences is FALSE? The custom of attaching locks on bridges ☐ was made popular by an Italian novel. ☐ is prohibited in Rome. ☐ follows an Italian tradition. ☐ was exported to Paris.	☐	☐	☐
3. The phrase "padlocks have spread like fungus" means that ☐ fungus appear on the bridges where padlocks are attached. ☐ padlocks are attached mainly on historic bridges. ☐ eight bridges over the river Seine were seriously deteriorated. ☐ padlocks have appeared in great quantities and very quickly.	☐	☐	☐
4. The municipal authorities in Paris decided to eradicate this practice ☐ after they had removed padlocks from bridges several times. ☐ when part of a historic bridge fell because of the weight of the locks. ☐ only when the eight bridges got covered by 500 kilograms of locks. ☐ when the railings of the Pont des Arts had to be removed.	☐	☐	☐
5. The city of Paris is putting panels of glass on bridges ☐ to protect the locks that are already attached. ☐ to let people see the locks more safely. ☐ to prevent the damage that the locks cause. ☐ to make an experiment on the bridges.	☐	☐	☐
6. According to the text, padlock sellers ☐ are making profits from this epidemic. ☐ sell only heart-shaped padlocks. ☐ tell you where you must put yours. ☐ sell them only through their website.	☐	☐	☐
7. Love-locks ☐ are restricted in European cities, like Paris or London. ☐ are limited to bridges or fences. ☐ are not found in non-tourist destinations. ☐ can now be found in a variety of places.	☐	☐	☐
8. Lisa Anselmo thinks that it would be a good idea for local authorities ☐ to assign a place for people to attach their locks. ☐ to restrict love-locks anywhere in the city. ☐ to keep love-locks in historic areas. ☐ to forbid love-locks everywhere, once and for all.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió escrita

Part 2: Writing

Choose ONE topic. Write about number 1 or 2. Minimum length: 100 words.
[4 points]

1. Are love-locks romantic or a menace? Write a for or against essay about this practice.

2. Imagine you are Carolyn Barnabo. Write an entry in your blog explaining how your views on love-locks have changed over the years.

Grammar	
Vocabulary	
Text	
Maturity	
Total	
Nota de la redacció	

Part 3: Listening comprehension

AN INTERVIEW WITH A CHAMPION

In the following conversation you are going to hear some new words. Read and listen to them. Make sure you know what they mean.

catch up with (to catch up with): retrobar-se amb, tornar-se a trobar amb / reencontrarse con, volverse a encontrar con
practice: entrenament / entreno
odd: estrany / extraño
social networks: xarxes socials / redes sociales
insight: percepció / percepción
leisure: lleure, temps lliure / ocio, tiempo libre

Ready?

Now read the questions on the following page. Read them carefully before listening to the conversation.

Reporter: Each year at this time since 2009, tennis player Chris Jules has been coming to New York City and leaving with the US Open trophy. Jules, who is 33 and among the top tennis practitioners, has no immediate plans to retire. Last August he won the Western Open title and was in the semifinals in Wimbledon in July. In November he was in the London Masters final. In today's program, he's interviewed by our sports reporter.

[Now listen to the interview.]

QUESTIONS

Choose the best answer according to the recording. Only ONE answer is correct.

[2 points: 0.25 points for each correct answer. Wrong answers will be penalized by deducting 0.08 points. There is no penalty for unanswered questions.]

Look at number 0 as an example.

0. Chris Jules
- ☒ is one of the best tennis players in the world.
- ☐ did not play in London last year.
- ☐ started playing tennis in 2009.
- ☐ is going to retire at 33 years old.

1. According to the interview, Chris Jules
- ☐ thinks he is old and not in his best shape this year.
- ☐ feels he's much better this year than the previous one.
- ☐ thinks time flies when he is in New York City.
- ☐ says he has not been in New York City since 2009.

2. Which of these things is the hardest for Jules when he leaves home?
- ☐ Being away from his home country.
- ☐ Leaving his children.
- ☐ Leaving his wife.
- ☐ Packing to go abroad.

3. When did Jules start loving tennis practice?
- ☐ When he was between 16 and 21 years old.
- ☐ When he became a professional tennis player.
- ☐ When he decided not to play for more than 45 minutes.
- ☐ When a professional coach told him how to do it.

4. Today, Jules's favorite time playing tennis is when
- ☐ there are a lot of people observing what he does.
- ☐ people are happy watching him win a game.
- ☐ he is alone and no one is observing what he does.
- ☐ people take photos of him practising.

5. According to the interview, which of the following statements is TRUE?
- ☐ Jules likes being alone in his hotel room, so he closes his door.
- ☐ Jules's wife has always travelled with him to all games.
- ☐ Jules's wife did not travel with him the last time he went to Barcelona.
- ☐ Jules's children are always alone at home so they open their house to friends.

6. According to Jules, tennis has changed in the last ten years
- ☐ because players are more aggressive now.
- ☐ but not as much as it did in the past.
- ☐ because players never move to the front.
- ☐ thanks to racket technology.

7. What does Jules say about Facebook and Twitter?
- ☐ He likes to use the social media to express his own ideas.
- ☐ He first went into Twitter and then Facebook because it was easier.
- ☐ People don't like what Jules says on Facebook but he does not care.
- ☐ He found Facebook easy, so he quickly learnt how to use it.

8. What does Jules like to do in his leisure time?
- ☐ To catch up with family and living a busy life.
- ☐ To listen to the waves and keeping quiet.
- ☐ To meet up with friends and going to the beach.
- ☐ To play other sports such as soccer.

Espai per al corrector/a

	Correcta	Incorrecta	No contestada
1.	☐	☐	☐
2.	☐	☐	☐
3.	☐	☐	☐
4.	☐	☐	☐
5.	☐	☐	☐
6.	☐	☐	☐
7.	☐	☐	☐
8.	☐	☐	☐

	Correctes	Incorrectes	No contestades
Recompte de les respostes			

Nota de comprensió oral

Etiqueta del corrector/a

Etiqueta identificadora de l'alumne/a

Institut d'Estudis Catalans

L'Institut d'Estudis Catalans ha tingut cura de la correcció lingüística i de l'edició d'aquesta prova d'accés